



## Audience involvement and film tourism experiences: Emotional places, emotional experiences

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### ABSTRACT

This study attempted to investigate the extent to which audience involvement or engagement with a serialised TV drama affects their actual on-site film tourism experiences at its former filmed locations. As an empirical study, an on-site survey was conducted at Daejanggeum Theme Park, the main filmed location of *Jewel in the Palace*, known in Korean as *Daejanggeum*, in Yangju, South Korea. The results indicated that audience's emotional and behavioural involvement was the main driver that positively affected their on-site film tourism experiences. Cognitively oriented audience involvement including cognitive interaction and critical reflection, however, was not considered as one of the major vehicles to construct and influence audience viewing experiences and their subsequent on-site film tourism experiences. The results also identified that the more emotional involvement audience develops through viewing the TV drama, the greater the likelihood of them visiting film tourism locations.

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### 1. Introduction

A long tradition of 'ocularcentricism' in Western culture (Synnott, 1993) and the increased visualisation of culture and society through the very consumable popular media have been challenging the conventional tourism spaces and its associated tourist experiences (Urry, 1990, 1994). A body of theoretical literature in tourism studies suggests that to a greater extent (popular) media play a vital role in shaping tourist motivations and influencing destination image and tourist visitation patterns (Butler, 1990; Croy, 2010; Kim & Richardson, 2003; Laing & Crouch, 2009; Macionis & Sparks, 2009; Schofield, 1996). Furthermore, tourist's anticipations, expectations and experiences are constructed and contextualised by televisual and cinematic narratives and mediated representations of other lands or even periods with embedded signs, myths and symbolic meanings (Couldry, 1998; Edensor, 2001; Feifer, 1985; Kim, 2010; Portegies, 2010; Urry, 1990, 1994).

Accordingly, academic consideration of close relationships between film, TV and tourism is increasingly growing, and it has created new forms of tourism, the so-called film-induced tourism (see Beeton, 2005; Connell, 2005a; Kim, Long, & Robinson, 2009; Macionis & Sparks, 2009; Mordue, 2009; Riley, Baker, & Van Doren, 1998; Roesch, 2009). In some of previous studies, such

touristic phenomenon is defined as film-induced tourism/film tourism (Beeton, 2005), movie-induced tourism (Riley et al., 1998), media-related tourism (Busby & Klug, 2001), and screen-tourism (Connell & Meyer, 2009; S. Kim et al., 2009). In this paper, Beeton's definition of *film tourism* referring to "visitation to sites where movies and TV programmes have been filmed as well as to tours to production studios, including film-related theme parks" (Beeton, 2005, p. 11) is adopted considering the widespread use of the term in its related tourism literature.

Despite anecdotal evidence of film tourism phenomenon around the world, there are some critical gaps in the way the phenomenon has been approached to date. First, there is a general lack of cross-disciplinary fertilisation between tourism and media studies (e.g. television, audience reception, media effects) (Beeton, 2010). Secondly, the main research focus remains primarily on business-related issues including destination marketing, branding and image, destination choice and motivation, and impacts and management (Beeton, 2010; S. Kim et al., 2009). Thirdly, although there are some exceptions to the research on the film site tourist experiences (Beeton, 2005; Macionis & Sparks, 2009; Roesch, 2009), there is relatively little sustained research that has explored the understanding of film tourism experiences associated with TV programmes (Connell & Meyer, 2009; Kim, 2010). In particular, there is a general lack of research on how audience's TV viewing experiences associated with audience responses to and engagement with a TV programme's outputs influence film tourism experiences (S. Kim et al., 2009).

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From audience reception and media effects studies, a body of theoretical and empirical research on audience involvement and engagement with media content in particular stories and characters, however has been well documented (see D.K. Kim et al., 2009; Kim & Rubin, 1997; Rubin & McHugh, 1987; Rubin, Perse, & Powell, 1985; Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000). Similarly, a range of similar terms and theoretical approaches have been suggested in previous studies on film tourism: Vicarious involvement (Kim & Richardson, 2003; Riley et al., 1998; Riley & Van Doren, 1992; Schofield, 1996); empathic involvement (Kim & Richardson, 2003); and celebrity involvement (Lee, Scott, & Kim, 2008). These studies collectively suggest that audience's personal engagement with TV programme and film create personalised memory and its associated symbolic meanings, and shape audience's feeling, emotions and attitudes toward places. According to Couldry (1998) and Kim (2010), these are important factors to better understand film tourism destinations and its experiences. Yet, empirical study remains under-researched in tourism studies by drawing on audience involvement theory from media and communication studies.

Thus, this study introduces the concept of audience involvement to the field of tourism studies, and attempts to examine the extent to which the level of audience involvement with a serialised TV drama affects their actual on-site film tourism experiences at former filmed locations. The geographical focus of the research is Daejanggeum Theme Park, South Korea, the filming location for the Korean historical television drama *Daejanggeum* (hereafter *DJG*) known in English as *Jewel in the Palace*. *DJG* is a key production to study due to the unprecedented high audience ratings in many foreign countries and the unprecedented international visitor numbers that it created, which has now been acknowledged nationally in Korea (S. Kim et al., 2009).

## 2. Literature review

### 2.1. Media consumption, everyday life and tourism

The media is a major cultural form increasingly constructing and shaping more social and cultural activities, events and experiences which people encounter and interpret in their daily lives. One inevitably continues to be exposed to various forms of the media, whether or not those are touristically promoted. With the help of immediate consumption and experience of visual images, the media act as 'pull' factors (Riley & Van Doren, 1992) for a prospective tourist by generating awareness, interest and appeal in the geographical locations and imaginations which they feature. It also constructs guidelines of tourist's anticipation and experience in portrayed locations, whereas one's subjective imaginations can bring him or her to the point where he or she goes in search of sensory experience.

In a broader context, people are increasingly depending more on contextualised knowledge, visual images and representations provided by the media for understanding and experiencing actual images or reality and stereotypes of the life situation of others. Regardless of the representations of reality being authentic or inauthentic and real or unreal, an individual's perceptions of a country, a place, or a culture are more decisively influenced by (visual) media exposures and repetitions when there are little direct cultural contacts or experiences (Babad, Max, & Dean, 1983). In a similar vein, given media programming challenges the lines between fictional and real landscapes, Appadurai (1990, p. 299) suggests that "...the further away the audiences are from the direct experiences of metropolitan life the more likely are to construct 'imagined worlds' which are chimerical, aesthetic, even fantastic objects....".

The consumption of visualised images and representations of a place or a country, therefore, forms some basic perceptions of an individual's understanding of the place, and thus creates expectations and imaginations of what he or she would experience at the place when they themselves actually become tourists visiting. According to Shields (1991), this perception is called 'place-myths' which is a similar term of Appadurai's 'imaged worlds', that is, stereotypes and clichés associated with particular location, in circulation of mediated images and representations of the place within a society. Whereas 'place-myths' are not necessarily faithful to the actual realities of a site, they are mixture of images and imaginations, which are often mixed together, consumed and after some time possibly replaced.

Urry (1990, p. 3) expresses that "such anticipation is constructed and sustained through a variety of non-tourist practices such as film, TV, literature, magazines, records and videos, which (re) construct and reinforce the gaze". Indeed, the non-tourism-related cultural and social practices have been playing a vital role in constructing tourism spaces and tourist experiences in the context of contemporary tourism. In order to experience many of the typical objects of the tourist gaze, people therefore can gaze upon, compare, and contextualise all sorts of different places with consumption of those non-tourism-related popular media without corporeal mobility conventionally associated with tourist movements (Feifer, 1985). Accordingly, people's initial experiences with any locations are primarily through the (popular) media consumption, so reality is the secondary comparison (Altheide, 1997). Prospective tourists are deemed to be drawn to destinations through the assimilation of images of places used as backgrounds and foregrounds in the (popular) media productions. Tourism then is a visual encounter with a place that is coded as distant, both spatially and temporally. When one visits an actual place, he or she might therefore feel that the place seems strangely familiar even though he or she has never previously visited.

### 2.2. Film tourism and film tourists' experiences

Reflecting the increasingly close relationships between tourism and the consumption of film and TV programmes, earlier studies on film tourism mainly focused on the visitation increases at locations of selected films and TV programmes (Riley et al., 1998; Riley & Van Doren, 1992; Tooke & Baker, 1996). More recent research highlights the interlinked issues of destination image and perception (Croy, 2010; Kim & Richardson, 2003), motivation (Macionis & Sparks, 2009), destination marketing (Beeton, 2005; Connell, 2005a; Hudson & Ritchie, 2006a, 2006b), destination branding (O'Connor & Bolan, 2008), and host community (Beeton, 2005, 2007; Connell, 2005b).

However, as suggested by Connell and Meyer (2009), the research literature with regard to the experiences of film tourists remains substantially unexplored and consequently there is little understanding of how film tourists perceive, experience, and interact with the filmed locations. Yet, some progress has been made in terms of understanding the area through previous studies conducted by Couldry (1998), Carl, Kinson, and Smith (2007), Kim et al. (2007), Roesch (2009), and Kim (2010). Carl et al. (2007) investigated the on-site experiences of film tourists visiting Hobbiton/Matamata and Wellington, two main locations of *The Lord of the Rings* (LOTR) in New Zealand. They suggested that tourists as audiences with a higher degree of involvement and consumption through their personal viewing experiences were more likely to be satisfied with their film tourism experiences. Those tourists with a higher degree of involvement were even willing to re-enact actions or scenes from the film in order to experience the filmed landscapes from the perspectives of the film's characters.

Similarly, Kim's (2010) work on *Winter Sonata*, a Korean TV drama series provides useful insights, highlighting that previous viewing experiences of a TV series not only create personalised memories and attachment with its filmed locations but also inspire film tourists to enhance their touristic experiences by re-enacting cinematic scenes from the series. In this regard, Couldry (1998) suggests that becoming a film tourist may fulfil considerable amounts of emotional investment. In addition, Roesch (2009) using Urry's 'romantic gazing', claims that most LOTR film tourists attached intrinsically deeper meanings to the filmed locations involving emotional and empathetic spatial involvement. The same author emphasises that for film tourists, especially purposeful rather than incidental film tourists, the filmed locations were experienced "as sacred places rather than as sites of spectacle" (Roesch, 2009, p. 134). Indeed, this is similar to what Couldry (1998) labels film tourism locations as "ritual sites". It is aligned with the argument that viewing experience and its subsequent actual experience with the locations depicted in the programme is considered as one that is highly personalised, subjective and unique to each individual based on their own pleasure, emotion, imagination, interpretation, and memory.

Likewise, the significance of such emotional bond between tourists as audiences and filmed locations in terms of film tourism experiences is well documented in the work of Riley et al. (1998) which suggests that personal engagement with popular media consumption associated with familiarity, empathy, identification and reflection would allow greater personalised symbolic meanings to the beholders of the gaze and in turn enhance the location's images. In this regard, Kim (2010) suggests that film tourists appear to attach an emotional bond or link between themselves and film tourism locations and to recall what they were touched by during the previous viewing experiences and its meanings with an emphasis on fantasy, nostalgia, memory and emotion, as opposed to merely gazing at the sites. However, further empirical studies would be beneficial to better understand film tourism experiences.

### 2.3. Audience involvement

Audience involvement has been regarded as an important construct of media uses and effects and as a characteristic of proactive audiences that purposefully seek and experience the media to fulfil certain expectations and needs in the media and communication studies. A range of operationalising the concept of audience involvement has been attempted. Rubin and Perse (1987a) used co-viewing distractions and cognitive involvement to measure audience involvement of viewers with TV news programme. Kim and Rubin (1997) and Perse (1990) adapted a cognitive 'Elaboration scale' to assess audience involvement with soap opera and TV news, respectively. Nevertheless, earlier media effects studies examined audience involvement as parasocial interaction (see Kim & Rubin, 1997; Perse & Rubin, 1988, 1989; Rubin & Perse, 1987b; Rubin et al., 1985), because parasocial interaction is treated as shorthand for the cognitive and affective reactions (Schiappa, Gregg, & Hewes, 2005), interpersonal involvement (Rubin et al., 1985), affective bonds (Kim & Rubin, 1997), and as one essential component of audience involvement (Sood & Rogers, 2000).

The concept of 'parasocial interaction' first appeared in a paper by Horton and Wohl (1956), where it was defined as an imaginary sense of intimacy by an individual audience member with a media figure. Previous studies have examined viewers' parasocial interaction mainly with television soap opera characters (Kim & Rubin, 1997; Papa et al., 2000; Perse & Rubin, 1988, 1989; Rubin & Perse, 1987b; Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000) as well as with television newscasters (Levy, 1979; Perse, 1990; Rubin et al., 1985) and

favourite television performers (Rubin & McHugh, 1987). Given the complex nature of audience involvement associated with an active psychological participation in media content, more recent research suggests that the concept of audience involvement should be multi-dimensional rather than uni-dimensional (e.g. affective/emotional parasocial interaction). In this regard, numerous studies assessed audience involvement not only by the affective, cognitive, and behavioural dimensions of parasocial interaction but also by critical and referential reflection (Bae & Lee, 2004; Papa et al., 2000; Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000).

In light of these studies, after initial exposure to a medium, repeated face-to-face interaction with media personalities, in particular through long-running soap operas or television dramas, may lead an audience member to begin experiencing feelings of intimacy with the character as if they were a close friend. Often, audiences completely immerse themselves in the situation, albeit artificially, and react to the actors as if they were real persons in their immediate environment. Especially, bipolar major features of serialised television dramas: 'intimacy' and 'continuity' or 'serialisation', engender a deeper degree of such audience involvement, a sense of gradually becoming identifiable, empathetic and discursive to a mass audience (Newcomb, 1974; Valaskivi, 2000).

As this mediated relationship intensifies, viewers make not only an investment of time by watching episodes on a regular basis, but also an emotional investment of loyalty, interest in the personalities' well-being, and 'dialoguing' by responding to personality questions or actions. Moreover, some audience members attempt to collect memorabilia or trivia about personalities and purchase products related to these media figures such as posters, DVDs, original sound tracks (OST), and so forth (Ferguson, 1992). Audience members with a high degree of audience involvement often seek personal contact with a media character (Horton & Wohl, 1956) or else by letter or mail, telephone, or some other means (Sood & Rogers, 2000) in order to affirm their emotional attachment to the character and the programme.

Analogously, it is assumed that these media-oriented post-viewing attitude and behaviour may function as a mediator influencing either directly or indirectly audience's willingness to attend fan group meetings or to visit filmed locations in the context of film tourism perspective. According to Schiappa et al. (2005), human beings are capable of making a distinction between fictional characters in a media programme and people they know in the real world. However, most of the times whilst watching television or film they may not make the effort to do so. Vorderer, Klimt, and Frittered (2004) call this process 'a temporary suspension of disbelief' of mediated fictional world of popular media programming, which allow audiences to have more intense entertainment experience.

### 2.4. Prospective audience involvement in film tourism

Some film tourism literature emphasise the importance of emotional representations, personal engagement and its symbolic meanings with popular dramatic film and TV outputs, in particular stories and characters (see Couldry, 1998; Kim & Richardson, 2003; Kim, 2010; Lee et al., 2008; Riley et al., 1998; Riley & Van Doren, 1992). A range of similar terms and approaches have been suggested in previous studies on film tourism: vicarious involvement/experience/consumption (Kim & Richardson, 2003; Riley et al., 1998; Riley & Van Doren, 1992), empathic involvement (Kim & Richardson, 2003), celebrity involvement (Lee et al., 2008), and emotional experience/involvement (Couldry, 1998; Kim, 2010). To a great extent, these concepts are similar to each other and assist in devising a theoretical framework for better understanding what role audience involvement plays in responding to entertainment

experience of popular media consumption. Also they help understand the extent to which they may influence film tourism-related tourist behaviour and experience. However, its empirical application to the tourism sphere and in particular to film tourism has gone virtually ignored.

Yet, Kim and Richardson (2003) empirically investigated the influence of “vicarious experience” with a movie on destination image changes. They attempted to understand “vicarious experience” through the concept of ‘empathic involvement’ by modifying an eight-item, five-point Likert scale, known as the VEDA (Viewer Empathy in Response to Drama Ads) scale. In similar, Lee et al. (2008) conducted an empirical study on the impact of celebrity fan involvement on destination image by modifying leisure involvement profile (IP) a twelve item, five-point Likert scale. However, contrary to theoretical support, neither empathic involvement nor celebrity fan involvement impacted on destination images toward locations depicted in films. According to Kim and Richardson (2003), it might be because the construct of vicarious experience or the construct of audience involvement is not as closely tied to empathic involvement as has been suggested in the marketing literature.

Therefore, it is suggested that re-conceptualised constructs and theoretically supported measurement scales of audience involvement would help better understand the intermingled relationships between popular media consumption and film tourism in particular, film tourism on-site experience. Also, the multi-dimensionality of audience involvement should be taken into account when conceptualising and operationalising its concept in the context of film tourism. Accordingly, adopting Sood's (2002) multi-dimensional audience involvement concept, this paper refines and conceptualises it as follows:

the degree to which audience members engage in reflection upon, and parasocial interaction with, certain media programmes, thus resulting in overt behaviour change. Audience involvement can be seen as being composed of two main elements: (a) reflection (critical and/or referential), and (b) parasocial interaction (cognitive, affective, behavioural participation or any combination of these) with the media (Sood, 2002, p. 156).

*Emotionally oriented interaction* is the degree to which audience members identify with characters or with other distinctive characteristics such as a location or storyline. Emotional/affective interaction not only includes identification with and liking for individual characters or celebrities, but also accounts for emotional reactions with production values of programme as a whole, such as the story, dialogues, situations, and even music (Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000). It was found that a high level of emotional interaction led the audiences to perceive the soap opera as reality, rather than fiction (Sood & Rogers, 2000). In contrast, *cognitively oriented interaction* refers to the degree to which audiences cognitively pay attention to particular characters or other distinctive characteristics of the programme and think about its educational/informational content once the programme is over. *Behaviourally oriented interaction* is the degree to which individuals talk to, or about, media characters during and after exposure and rearrange their schedules to make time for viewing (Papa et al., 2000; Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000).

*Referential reflection* is the degree to which an individual relates a media programme to his or her personal experiences. Similar to emotional parasocial interaction, the referential connects the programme and real life in terms of their own lives and problems, as if the viewers were relating to the characters as real people and in turn relating these real people to their own real worlds (Liebes & Katz, 1986; Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000). *Critical reflection* is

defined as the degree to which audience members distance themselves from, and engage in, production values of a media programme. With a higher degree of critical reflection, audience engages in reconstructing the programme by suggesting plot changes (Liebes & Katz, 1986). Referential readings are probably more emotionally involving, while critical readings are more distant, dealing as they do with genres, dynamics of plot, themes of the story and so on (Liebes & Katz, 1986; Sood, 2002).

### 3. Film tourism in Korea and Daejanggeum

As mentioned in some previous studies (see Kim et al., 2007; S. Kim et al., 2009; Lee et al., 2008), tourism agencies in Korea are claiming that the popularity of the *Hallyu* phenomenon has led to dramatic increases in international tourists arrivals to the country and specifically to locations and sites associated with Korean TV dramas. The *Hallyu* phenomenon, or the so-called ‘Korean wave’, refers to Korean-generated popular cultural products that includes TV dramas, movies, popular music, computer games, food and fashion, with these having achieved market penetration in South-East and East Asia in particular. The nexus of the *Hallyu* phenomenon lies in the circulation and popularity of Korean TV dramas.

According to KNTA (2005a), an estimated 3.86 million tourists from China, Japan, Hong Kong, Taiwan, Singapore and Thailand, where *Hallyu* has been particularly popular, visited Korea in 2004, representing 63 percent of the total number of inbound tourists (5.81 million). Although it is difficult to identify the numbers who came directly because of the *Hallyu* phenomenon, this figure represents a 31.81 percent growth over the previous year and is much higher than the 8.7 percent growth rate of tourists from other countries. KNTA (2005a, 2005b, 2006) suggests that more than 5 million foreign tourists have visited the filmed locations of two Korean television dramas, *Winter Sonata* and *Daejanggeum*. In other words, it is suggested that around one in seven inbound tourists is considered to be ‘film tourist’ associated with Korean ‘TV drama pilgrimage’. However, as suggested by Croy and Heitmann (2011), it should be noted that such reported influence and numbers often appear to be overstated and dramatically higher than other international research. Yet, there is no doubt an influence and impact of these TV series on inbound tourism patterns in Korea.

*Hallyu*-related tourism thus is based on visitation to the locations and sets of tourists’ favourite TV dramas as a form of film tourism. In this regard, the two most popular destinations are ‘Nami Island’, a location for romantic scenes in *Winter Sonata*, and ‘Daejanggeum Theme Park’, a film set for *DJG*. Especially, *DJG* was one of the most popular *Hallyu* television dramas. *DJG* is set around the late 15th to the early 16th century and is based on references within the Annals of the Chosun Dynasty on a female doctor of that time named Seo Jang-Geum who possessed unparalleled skills in the medical field and who was a cook in the royal kitchen before becoming the first female royal physician. Historically accurate depictions of the Korean Royal Palace, and the cuisine and medical treatments of that time are presented throughout the serial. *DJG* was screened in Korea from September 2003 to March 2004 and was identified as a national drama in Korea in 2004, when it attained the highest audience ratings in Korean television history (57.8%) (KNTA, 2005a). The serial has now been broadcast in over 60 countries including Taiwan, Hong Kong, China, Japan, Thailand, Singapore, and Malaysia.

Also, *DJG* achieved unprecedented high audience ratings in many countries. For example, it was extremely popular in Hong Kong where it was the most popular television drama in history, boasting an averaged audience rating of 37 percent and a top viewer rating of 49 percent, meaning that over 3 million people out of Hong Kong’s entire 6.9 million population tuned in at its peak.



The strong audience appeal resulted in the broadcasting time being moved forward from 23:00 to 22:00 (KNTV, 2005a). Daejanggeum Theme Park located in Yangju, Gyeonggi province, has recently become the most popular destination for film tourism associated with the *Hallyu* phenomenon. This outdoor drama set has been restored to exactly the way it was when *DJG* was being filmed there. A theme park concept has also been developed with a variety of events and programmes for visitors to experience. Since opening in November 2004, the theme park has already attracted over 310,000 international visitors as at June 2006.

#### 4. Research methods

##### 4.1. Measurement

Survey methods were used to collect data. Major variables in the questionnaire are audience involvement and on-site film tourism experiences at former filmed locations. Audience involvement was measured using Sood's (2002) audience involvement scale with five dimensional model (affectively oriented interaction, cognitively oriented interaction, behaviourally oriented interaction, referential reflection, and critical reflection) for the following reason. Sood's audience involvement scale is the most comprehensive instrument for measuring audience involvement, because the scale was purposely developed for entertainment–education (E–E) media programmes (most TV dramas contain such entertainment–education messages) by synthetically analysing and conceptualising previous studies on audience involvement (see Levy, 1979; Liebes & Katz, 1986; Papa et al., 2000; Rubin & Perse, 1987a; Rubin et al., 1985; Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000). Also, this scale was used in Sood's study of "Audience involvement and entertainment–education" and the validity and reliability of the scale were tested. With slight modification, a total of 29 items were selected and a five-point Likert-type scale (1 = strongly disagree to 5 = strongly agree) was utilised to measure the construct.

Regarding the on-site film tourism experience scale, the subjectivity and complexity of tourists' experiences with a tourism destination has suggested that no single established scale exists to measure on-site tourists' experiences generally and on-site film tourists' experiences in particular. Thus, similar to the study of Kim et al. (2007), this study attempted to develop an appropriate research instrument for this study-specified film tourists' experiences items. A 20 item on-site film tourists' experiences with Daejanggeum Theme Park was generated from a review of previous studies that have been qualitatively analysed. The Daejanggeum Theme Park brochure and its details of facilities provided for visitors at the location were also taken into account. The 20 items of on-site film tourists' experiences included a mix of multi-sensory experience attributes. In addition, some of the 20 items were associated with sensory/symbolic experience, beyond screen-experience, and celebrity and character oriented experience. Respondents were asked to indicate their levels of agreement on each item based on their own touristic experiences at the Daejanggeum Theme Park during their visit. Again, a 5-point Likert scale was used for each measure with items scored 1 for "strongly disagree" and 5 for "strongly agree".

The questionnaire was initially written in English, translated into Chinese, Japanese and Thai, and checked by respective first language speaking academics in tourism studies. As the final step, the revised translated versions of survey questionnaires were re-confirmed by a group of U.K. residents and postgraduate students (collected by convenient sampling) originally from those languages speaking countries including Taiwan, China, Japan, and Thailand. Despite the back-translation of survey instruments recommended (Iwashita, 2003; Livingston, 2003), these steps convincingly led to

ensure comparability of the measures translated in these three foreign languages and to confirm that prospective participants in the main survey would have no problem in reading and understanding the measures of the questionnaire and in turn meaningfully choose answers.

##### 4.2. Sample size, data collection, and data analyses

Before the main survey, a pilot study was undertaken with two main objectives: (1) to confirm the reliability of the scale and the validity of the content of the questionnaire, and (2) to retain or delete items of measurement scales. An advertisement to recruit volunteer participants for the pilot study was placed on the bulletin board of seven online fan clubs of Daejanggeum from May 5 to July 10, 2007. As a sample from a relevant population of interest is still preferred (Netemeyer, Bearden, & Sharma, 2003), two preconditions of becoming volunteers were mentioned: (1) audience who had already watched at least some episodes of *DJG* and (2) audience who are originally Asian including Japanese, Chinese, Thai, and so on. A total of 101 questionnaires were collected and 83 responses became the basis for factor analysis. Eighteen responses were excluded due to questionnaires being 25 percent or more incomplete or unfaithful responses (Sekaran, 2003). As a result, a set of 20 items were finally selected to measure the level of audience involvement with initial deletions of nine items, whereas two items of on-site film tourism experiences were initially deleted and in turn a set of 18 items remained for the main survey. The remained items all fulfilled the thresholds of communality, factor loading, and anti-image correlation with meritorious internal consistency (Hair, Anderson, Tatham, & Black, 1998; Netemeyer et al., 2003).

The main on-site survey was conducted at the Daejanggeum Theme Park, the main filmed location of *DJG* on both weekdays and weekends (August 22 to October 1, 2007). Convenience sampling was the method of choice for the study since it was not physically possible to control for the visitor's passage. The respondents selected for this study consisted of only Asian tourists including Japanese, Chinese, Taiwanese and Thai who already watched *DJG* in their home countries. A total of 754 questionnaires were collected and the response rate was 67 percent. Fifty-five of the collected questionnaires were screened out because of missing data accounting for more than 25 percent of total answered questions (Sekaran, 2003). Therefore, a pool of 701 usable responses was finally used for the following data analyses.

The data in this study were analysed with exploratory factor analysis (EFA) and multiple regression analysis using SPSS 17.0. A series of EFA were initially conducted to identify the underlying dimensions of two variables: audience involvement and on-site film tourism experiences at the former filmed locations. Next, reliability coefficients with extracted domains were calculated to measure the internal consistency among the items. Finally, a series of multiple regression analysis were used to identify the relationships between audience involvement and on-site film tourism experiences.

#### 5. Results

##### 5.1. Respondents' characteristics and factor analyses

Table 1 presents the respondents' characteristics, including their nationality, gender, age and the highest education level.

Respondents were near equally from each of the four target nationalities. Females represent two-thirds of the sample. The respondents' ages spread across the cohort categories, with 54.8 percent below the age of 40 and 45.2 percent above. The respondents mostly had a university qualification (77.7%).

**Table 1**  
Socio-demographics of the respondents ( $n = 701$ ).

|                 |                        | Frequency (N) | Percentage (%) |
|-----------------|------------------------|---------------|----------------|
| Nationality     | Chinese                | 178           | 25.4           |
|                 | Japanese               | 193           | 27.5           |
|                 | Thai                   | 162           | 24.0           |
|                 | Taiwanese              | 168           | 23.1           |
|                 | <b>Total</b>           | 701           | 100            |
| Gender          | Male                   | 219           | 31.5           |
|                 | Female                 | 477           | 68.5           |
|                 | <b>Total</b>           | 696           | 100            |
| Age             | Less than 20           | 32            | 4.8            |
|                 | 20–29                  | 188           | 28.5           |
|                 | 30–39                  | 142           | 21.5           |
|                 | 40–49                  | 150           | 22.8           |
|                 | 50–59                  | 111           | 16.8           |
|                 | 60 or more             | 37            | 5.6            |
|                 | <b>Total</b>           | 660           | 100            |
| Education level | Primary                | 7             | 1.0            |
|                 | Middle                 | 17            | 2.5            |
|                 | High                   | 129           | 18.8           |
|                 | Undergraduate          | 428           | 62.4           |
|                 | Postgraduate or higher | 105           | 15.3           |
|                 | <b>Total</b>           | 686           | 100            |

The 20 items of experienced audience involvement with *DJG* was subjected to principle component factor analysis with 'varimax' rotation method that seeks to maximise variances of the loadings in a certain predetermined fashion. After inspection of item content for domain representation, 5 items exhibiting high cross loadings were deleted. As demonstrated in Table 2, a final three-factor model was estimated with the remaining 15 items. The factor solution accounted for 65.482 percent of the total variance. Bartlett's test of sphericity was significant ( $p < .000$ ) and KMO measure of sampling adequacy (.919) exceeded the minimum value (.60) which indicates

that the factor analysis was considered a useful validation of the factor model. In the screeplot test, the Eigenvalue for the first factor was the highest but decreasing for the next two factors that had an Eigenvalue greater than 1.0. These findings provide evidence for the construct validity of the scale (Churchill, 1979). The three dimensions are named 'behavioural involvement (dimension 1)', 'emotional involvement (dimension 2)', and 'referential reflection (dimension 3)'. The results of reliability test indicate that the three factors all had meritorious internal consistency with a coefficient of .879, .883, and .824. Therefore, it supports the argument that these three factors to measure experienced audience involvement were reliable and had internal consistency of items on each factor or domain.

Factor loadings which measure correlation between the observed measurements and the factors ranged from .559 to .795 on the three domains. Meanwhile, communalities for each variable which show the amount of variances accounted for by the factors were from .426 to .771, indicating each variable contribute to establishing the factor structure. According to Hair et al. (1998), communalities of measure are acceptable at a level of at least .40, whereas factor loadings should be  $\pm .50$  or greater for practical significance although the lowest factor loading to be considered significant would in most exploratory studies be greater than  $\pm .30$ . Thus, the results of this study satisfied the recommended thresholds for both factor loadings and communalities.

In a similar manner, an exploratory principle component analysis with a varimax rotation was performed to determine the dimensional structure of the on-site film tourists' experiences at the Daejanggeum Theme Park. Bartlett's test of sphericity was statistically significant at the level of .000 ( $p < .000$ ) and KMO measure of sampling adequacy (.952) largely exceeded the minimum value (.60), which indicates that the measures of the on-site film tourists' experiences were appropriate for factoring. With an initial deletion of 6 items exhibiting high cross loadings, the remaining 12 items were empirically summarised by a three-factor

**Table 2**  
Results of factor analysis and its three dimensions: audience involvement with *DJG* ( $n = 701$ ).

|                                                                                                                                     | Mean <sup>a</sup> | Std.<br>deviation | Factor loadings |          |          | Com <sup>b</sup> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------|----------|----------|------------------|
|                                                                                                                                     |                   |                   | Factor 1        | Factor 2 | Factor 3 |                  |
| <i>Behavioural involvement</i> (dimension 1)                                                                                        |                   |                   |                 |          |          |                  |
| If my favourite character(s)/actor(s) appeared on another programme, I would watch that programme.                                  | 3.76              | .868              | .771            |          |          | .683             |
| I found my favourite character(s)/actor(s) in <i>DJG</i> to be attractive.                                                          | 3.97              | .831              | .758            |          |          | .679             |
| If there was a story about <i>DJG</i> or my favourite character(s)/actor(s) in a newspaper, internet, or magazine, I would read it. | 3.69              | .879              | .756            |          |          | .703             |
| I felt sad for my favourite character(s)/actor(s) when they made a mistake, or when bad things happened to them.                    | 3.73              | .861              | .722            |          |          | .643             |
| I looked forward to watching <i>DJG</i> and my favourite character(s)/actor(s) in each episode.                                     | 3.73              | .935              | .681            |          |          | .634             |
| I sometimes made remarks to my favourite character(s)/actor(s) while watching <i>DJG</i> .                                          | 3.64              | .833              | .559            |          |          | .426             |
| <i>Emotional involvement</i> (dimension 2)                                                                                          |                   |                   |                 |          |          |                  |
| When watching <i>DJG</i> , I felt that I was a part of the story.                                                                   | 3.07              | .956              |                 | .775     |          | .692             |
| My favourite character(s)/actor(s) in <i>DJG</i> were like old friends.                                                             | 3.13              | .918              |                 | .734     |          | .696             |
| I was determined to meet my favourite character(s)/actor(s) on <i>DJG</i> in person.                                                | 3.40              | 1.008             |                 | .727     |          | .640             |
| I liked hearing the voice of my favourite character(s)/actor(s) in my home.                                                         | 3.31              | .914              |                 | .713     |          | .668             |
| I arranged my daily/weekly schedule around <i>DJG</i> so as to have a regular relationship with the programme.                      | 3.28              | 1.015             |                 | .643     |          | .592             |
| I felt that the <i>DJG</i> and my favourite character(s)/actor(s) kept me company.                                                  | 3.27              | .841              |                 | .639     |          | .531             |
| <i>Referential reflection</i> (dimension 3)                                                                                         |                   |                   |                 |          |          |                  |
| I felt that <i>DJG</i> portrayed real life lessons and practices that I could personally relate to.                                 | 3.60              | .876              |                 |          | .795     | .771             |
| I felt that <i>DJG</i> presented things as they really are in life.                                                                 | 3.77              | .805              |                 |          | .788     | .721             |
| <i>DJG</i> seemed to understand and cover the kinds of issues that I wanted to know more about.                                     | 3.55              | .861              |                 |          | .740     | .744             |
| Eigenvalues                                                                                                                         |                   |                   | 7.652           | 1.150    | 1.020    |                  |
| % of Variance                                                                                                                       |                   |                   | 51.012          | 7.668    | 6.802    | Total: 65.482    |
| Reliability coefficient                                                                                                             |                   |                   | .879            | .883     | .824     |                  |

<sup>a</sup> Items measured on a 5-point Likert scale.

<sup>b</sup> Denotes communality.

**Table 3**Results of factor analysis and its three dimensions: film tourists' experiences at the Daejanggeum Theme Park ( $n = 701$ ).

|                                                                                                                                                                                            | Mean <sup>a</sup> | Std.<br>deviation | Factor loadings |          |          | Com <sup>b</sup> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------|----------|----------|------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                            |                   |                   | Factor 1        | Factor 2 | Factor 3 |                  |
| <i>Prestige and privilege (dimension 1)</i>                                                                                                                                                |                   |                   |                 |          |          |                  |
| I was excited to get close and to touch traditional costumes, cooking utensils, and other props from the drama                                                                             | 3.81              | .845              | .798            |          |          | .734             |
| I was excited to be able to be at the filmed locations of <i>DJG</i> in person.                                                                                                            | 3.83              | .850              | .792            |          |          | .759             |
| I was excited to see historical and cultural landscapes portrayed in the drama in person.                                                                                                  | 3.85              | .818              | .785            |          |          | .729             |
| I gazed at and took pictures of the details of the filmed locations of <i>DJG</i> that appeared on the screen.                                                                             | 3.86              | .817              | .675            |          |          | .584             |
| I took photos with standing posters of my favourite characters and celebrities.                                                                                                            | 3.86              | .917              | .622            |          |          | .485             |
| <i>Beyond screen, sensory experience and re-enactment (dimension 2)</i>                                                                                                                    |                   |                   |                 |          |          |                  |
| It was a great experience to taste a traditional Korean rice wine in the Brewery of Gang Duk Goo (Jang-Geum's stepfather) and some Korean snacks.                                          | 3.64              | .865              |                 | .823     |          | .734             |
| Alongside experiencing the filmed locations, it was a great experience to know more about the interesting stories on Korean royal cuisine in the video display.                            | 3.83              | .857              |                 | .743     |          | .694             |
| It was a great experience to find out many behind the scenes stories about producing the drama such as the producer's filming journal, stories about <i>DJG</i> in history, and NG scenes. | 3.69              | .878              |                 | .729     |          | .674             |
| As if I was the main character, I was so excited to re-enact some scenes of <i>DJG</i> in person such the corporal punishments including flogging or trying pine nuts and pine twigs.      | 3.41              | .930              |                 | .645     |          | 536              |
| <i>Intimacy and memory (dimension 3)</i>                                                                                                                                                   |                   |                   |                 |          |          |                  |
| I immediately recognised all the things as they had appeared on the screen.                                                                                                                | 3.55              | .900              |                 |          | .780     | .750             |
| I found myself to be familiar with these locations.                                                                                                                                        | 3.32              | .957              |                 |          | .773     | .697             |
| The stories from <i>DJG</i> went through my mind as I was here.                                                                                                                            | 3.78              | .859              |                 |          | .752     | .739             |
| Eigenvalues                                                                                                                                                                                |                   |                   | 5.958           | 1.112    | 1.044    |                  |
| % of Variance                                                                                                                                                                              |                   |                   | 49.648          | 9.271    | 8.702    | Total: 67.620    |
| Reliability coefficient                                                                                                                                                                    |                   |                   | .867            | .823     | .788     |                  |

<sup>a</sup> Items measured on a 5-point Likert scale.<sup>b</sup> Denotes communality.

solution which accounted for 67.620 percent of the variance. Table 3 summarises the outcomes of the factor analysis. The factor loadings were all greater than .60 ranging from .622 to .823. This resulted in the following renamed three dimensions: 'Prestige and privilege (dimension 1)' that constitutes 5 items, 'Beyond screen, sensory experience, and re-enactment (dimension 2)' with 4 items, and 'Intimacy and memory (dimension 3)' with 3 items. The reliability tests indicate that all three dimensions of on-site film tourists' experiences including 'Prestige and privilege', 'Beyond screen, sensory experience, and re-enactment', and 'Intimacy and memory' had very good internal consistency with  $\alpha$  coefficient of .867, .823, and .788, respectively.

## 5.2. Results of multiple regression analyses to predict film tourists' experiences

Three multiple regression analyses were used to predict and explain a dependent variable using two or more independent

variables (see Table 4). The three dimensions of the audience involvement scale, as derived from factor analysis, were considered as independent variables, and each of the three dimensions of the on-site film tourist's experiences (e.g. 'prestige and privilege', 'beyond screen, sensory experience and re-enactment', and 'intimacy and memory') was considered as a dependent variable. In Table 4, in all the regression models, the overall model fit indices were statistically significant, which indicates that the audience involvement dimensions were statistically significant in estimating the on-site film tourists' experiences dimensions ( $p = .000$ ). The multiple  $R$  coefficients indicate that the correlation between the combined audience involvement scale and the combined on-site film tourists' experiences scale is moderate to strong across the models (all multiple  $R$  values  $\geq .30$ ). According to the  $R^2$  statistics, 48 percent of the total variance for the estimation of 'prestige and privilege' related on-site film tourists' experiences is explained by Model 1, 37.8 percent of the total variance for the estimation of 'beyond screen, sensory experience and re-enactment' related on-

**Table 4**Multiple regression analysis for predicting on-site film tourists' experiences ( $n = 701$ ).

| Independent variables: experienced audience involvement | Model 1<br>Prestige and privilege                                       |           | Model 2<br>Beyond screen, sensory experience and re-enactment           |          | Model 3<br>Intimacy and memory                                          |          |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
|                                                         | Std. beta coeff.                                                        | t-Value   | Std. beta coeff.                                                        | t-Value  | Std. beta coeff.                                                        | t-Value  |
| Behavioural involvement                                 | .480                                                                    | 11.832*** | .268                                                                    | 6.040*** | .269                                                                    | 6.377*** |
| Emotional involvement                                   | .087                                                                    | 2.072**   | .174                                                                    | 3.797*** | .321                                                                    | 7.349*** |
| Referential reflection (Constant)                       | .205                                                                    | 5.556***  | .260                                                                    | 6.462*** | .158                                                                    | 4.124*** |
|                                                         |                                                                         | 9.678***  |                                                                         | 8.933*** |                                                                         | 6.075*** |
| Overall model                                           | $R^2 = .480$<br>Adjusted $R^2 = .477$<br>Model $F(3, 697) = 214.058***$ |           | $R^2 = .378$<br>Adjusted $R^2 = .375$<br>Model $F(3, 697) = 141.009***$ |          | $R^2 = .438$<br>Adjusted $R^2 = .436$<br>Model $F(3, 697) = 181.017***$ |          |

Note: \*\* $p < .05$ , \*\*\* $p < .001$ .

site film tourists' experiences being explained by Model 2, and 38.6 percent of the total variance for the estimation of 'intimacy and memory' by Model 3. Furthermore, all three dimensions of audience involvement including behavioural, emotional and referential involvement were found to have a significant impact on the three dimensions of on-site film tourist's experiences ( $p = .000$ ) across all three models. Specifically, behavioural involvement was the most substantial contributor to 'prestige and privilege' ( $\beta = .480$ ,  $p < .001$ ) and 'beyond screen, sensory experience and re-enactment' related on-site film tourist's experiences ( $\beta = .268$ ,  $p < .001$ ), whereas emotional involvement made the largest unique contribution to the ones of 'intimacy and memory' ( $\beta = .321$ ,  $p < .001$ ). The findings of this paper confirm the research proposition, and therefore imply that audience involvement with a serialised television drama is an immediate antecedent of on-site film tourists' experiences at film tourism locations.

## 6. Implications and conclusion

The main purpose of this study was to investigate the extent to which the level of audience involvement with a serialised TV drama influences their actual tourism experiences at its film tourism location(s). A review of related literature on film tourism and media-communication studies in particular audience involvement theory generated a theoretical approach to interrelationship between TV drama viewing experiences and film tourism experiences. This theoretical approach was empirically tested using international visitors' survey data collected at Daejanggeum Theme Park, the main filmed location of *Daejanggeum*, a Korean historical TV drama, in South Korea.

The findings from this study have several theoretical implications and recommendations for future research. First of all, the study contributed to bridging the concept of audience involvement to film tourism destinations and its associated on-site experiences. Audience involvement is described in three dimensions: 'behavioural involvement', 'emotional involvement', and 'referential reflection', whereas the on-site film tourists' experiences encompass three dimensions: 'prestige and privilege', 'intimacy and memory', and 'beyond screen, sensory experience and re-enactment'. The dimensions were found to be reliable and valid. As such, the present study confirmed multi-dimensionality of audience involvement being consistent with the previous studies from the media and communication literature (Bae & Lee, 2004; Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000). However, it is interesting to note that contrary to previous studies (Sood, 2002; Sood & Rogers, 2000), cognitive involvement did not emerge as a distinct dimension, which indicates that cognitively oriented audience involvement including cognitive interaction/involvement and critical reflection was not considered as one of the major vehicles to construct and influence viewing experiences of serialised TV dramas as well as on-site film tourists' experiences in the context of film tourism phenomenon.

Furthermore, the dimension of behavioural involvement played the most significant role in explaining the level of on-site film tourists' experiences associated with and 'prestige and privilege' and 'beyond screen, sensory experience and re-enactment', while the one of emotional involvement was the most significant contributor to the 'intimacy and memory' related on-site film tourists' experiences. This may be explained by the fact that hedonic, physiological, affective, and/or emotional domain of audience involvement through simultaneously developing parasocial interaction, identification, empathy, and/or reflection from audiences' reception side are indeed at the centre of audience viewing experiences in particular, a genre of serialised TV dramas including soap operas (Creeber, 2001; Giles, 2002; Hobson, 2003; Kincaid, 2002).

Secondly, this study offered some empirical support for the idea that when viewers experience a higher level of audience involvement with the TV drama's contents such as character and celebrity, narrative and storyline, and music, their actual on-site tourism experiences at its filmed locations is perceived more positively and favourably. This is consistent with the findings of Carl et al.'s (2007) study on the *Lord of the Rings* (LOTR) film tourists which suggests that there was a strong correlation between the level of audience involvement and satisfaction of film tourism experiences. In comparison, two exemplified similar previous studies on destination image conducted by Kim and Richardson (2003) and Lee et al. (2008) did not empirically support that either vicarious involvement or celebrity involvement positively influenced tourists' perceptions of the destination closely related to the film/movie and celebrity figure(s). Thus, more studies are needed to refine conceptualisation of audience involvement in the film tourism context and to better understand the role of audience involvement plays in not only various tourism destination perceptions but also tourist experiences. Also, it would be beneficial to analyse the antecedents (e.g. media contents, production values) and consequences of audience involvement as well as the context within which it occurs.

This finding further reinforces some of previous studies on film tourism experiences at the former filmed location(s) (e.g. the set of *Coronation Street* and Nami Island of *Winter Sonata*), where personal emotional engagement or involvement not only formed personalised memory and attachment but also created new touristic spaces and contextualised anticipated touristic experiences at the filmed locations (Couldry, 1998; Kim, 2010). As Couldry (1998) emphasised the significance of considerable amounts of emotional investment during watching TV drama in better understanding on-site film tourism experiences that go beyond the obvious cognitive dimension of the locations as their fictive, this study empirically proved that behavioural and emotional involvement was an immediate antecedent of various dimensions of on-site film tourists' experiences.

This is in line with the argument of Riley et al. (1998) that personal emotional engagement with TV series consumption associated with familiarity, empathy, identification and reflection would allow greater personalised symbolic meanings to the beholders of the gaze. Such symbolic meanings create and contextualise symbolic touristic experiences (Kim, 2010). In this respect, a very recent research on film tourist experiences at the filmed locations of LOTR conducted by Buchmann, Moore, and Fisher (2010) suggested that such symbolic (authentic) experiences and embedded meanings and values emanate not only from objects/icons and sights but also from the very moment of embodied interaction with place(s) and others such as symbolised and contextualised previous viewing experiences and its memory. This in turn results in film tourists' experiences being appreciated as a memory structure and various symbolic dimensions of these spaces as ritual places through the complex imaginative and emotional involvement of audiences. This is exactly the case here, where film tourists attempted to remember and experience how they were emotionally and behaviourally touched by the story, characters and other production values (e.g. tailored background music, visual enhancement, and celebrity icons) in the screened reality (i.e. 'intimacy and memory' oriented film tourists' experiences). Also, they wanted to confirm iconic parts or everything of what was depicted on the screen through their eyes and camera lenses, as opposed to merely gazing at the site/sight (i.e. 'prestige and privilege'). Therefore, although Macionis and Sparks (2009) and Di Cesare, D'Angelo, and Rech (2009) further noted that visitation to film locations is an incidental tourism experience, the findings of this paper however suggest that the DJG film tourists are considered as specific or purposeful film tourists who actively seek



out places portrayed on TV as well as their personalised and symbolised meanings and values. From this perspective, this leads to suggest that understanding of psychological and experiential aspects of audience viewing experiences associated with affective bonds, intimacy, and emotional commitment between viewers and the programme is paramount for both researchers and the tourism industry to better understand on-site film tourists' experiences in the context of film tourism phenomenon.

Thirdly, the findings of this study empirically reveal that intensified audience involvement can significantly influence media-oriented post-viewing attitude and behaviour. That is, the results from this study support that one measurement of audience involvement such as "I was determined to meet my favourite character(s)/actor(s) on *DJG* in person" had the strongest correlations with the dimension of emotional involvement. The direct impact of emotional involvement on audience's destination choice process associated with film tourism destinations/locations was not within the scope of this study. However, to a greater or lesser extent, the more emotional involvement audience develops through viewing popular media programmes, for example serialised television drama, the greater the likelihood of them visiting film tourism locations. Therefore, more studies are needed to investigate how audience involvement in particular, emotional involvement with popular media programmes contributes to viewer's destination selection process and his/her touristic perception toward film tourism destinations.

From a practical standpoint, the findings also offer important implications for both popular media marketers and destination managers. Regarding the selection of popular media programmes to import or export, media marketers and merchandisers should pay closer attention to the content of textual, visual, and aural elements dealing with emotional and behavioural engagement rather than mere entertainment value. Therefore, media marketers, especially in Taiwan, Japan, Thailand, and China as well as in other Asian contexts, would be beneficial to import and/or export emotionally appealing, tear-jerking and melodramatic TV drama series. Also, media marketers may reap more benefits from developing and communicating strong emotional storytelling messages via advertising and marketing campaign when launching newly imported TV dramas in their locals. For destination managers, it is recommended to offer their destination(s)' provision and supply of anticipated film tourists' experiences related to symbolically and emotionally meaningful icons and attracts and their meanings, given the fact that the present study empirically observed that a deeper emotional connection between viewers and a TV drama is an important vehicle for the audiences to become film tourists. Furthermore, destination managers should develop and commoditise souvenirs containing emotional meaning and nostalgic values embedded in viewers' viewing experiences.

Despite the present study's contributions to the film tourism literature, it is appropriate to indicate the limitations of this research, which have to be taken into account when considering the study findings. Firstly, the study findings are specific to a particular genre of serialised Korean historical TV drama, and in turn cannot be generalised to all genres of TV programmes and films. Secondly, the sample population of the study was purposively restricted to tourists whose nationalities were one of those countries including Japan, Taiwan, Thailand, and China. Thus, the results should not be taken as representing the whole population of *DJG* viewers and film tourists who have visited Daejanggeum Theme Park. Accordingly, future research should replicate the study with a broader context including other countries such as Iran, India, Philippines, Brunei, Vietnam, Singapore, Indonesia, Hong Kong, and United States of America. Lastly, this study did not take into account the dynamics of international audience's viewing

experiences that entail some degree of contextualisation. As suggested by S. Kim et al. (2009) and Ryan, Yanning, Huimin, and Song (2009), the consumption of popular media (e.g. TV dramas, soap operas, films), its associated meanings, and film tourism experiences are contextualised within different social, cultural, linguistic and religious values and norms. Thus, future studies on film tourism and its associated film tourist experiences should be investigated and contextualised with more consideration of cultural perspectives.

## Appendix. Supplementary data

Supplementary data associated with this article can be found, in the online, version at doi:10.1016/j.tourman.2011.04.008.

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